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Pocket Positivity Trio

Sunny the Sunflower · Waddle the Penguin · Spud the Potato

Three palm-sized amigurumi designed to slip into a coat pocket. They work up fast — an evening or two for all three — and make excellent small gift add-ons, party favours, or a gentle first project.

The trio shares one body: a **six-stitch sphere for Waddle**, a **six-stitch cushion for Sunny**, and a **flat oval for Spud**. Once you have worked the first toy, the other two will feel familiar.

At a Glance

	Sunny	Waddle	Spud
Shape	Flat six-petal flower	Pear-shaped penguin	Rounded potato
Finished size	about 3.0 cm (1.2 in) across the petals	about 3.8 cm (1.5 in) tall	about 2.7 cm (1.1 in) long
Yarn weight	#4 worsted	#4 worsted	#4 worsted
Hook	3.5 mm (US E/4)	3.5 mm (US E/4)	3.5 mm (US E/4)
Time per toy	20–30 minutes	20–30 minutes	25–35 minutes

Sunny and Waddle have no separate pieces to sew. Spud is worked flat, then the seam is closed in one stitch. All three are worked in continuous spiral rounds with a stitch marker, so there is no slip stitch at the end of each round.

Materials

- **Yarn:** worsted weight / #4 (about 250 m per 100 g). The three toys use roughly 8 m of yarn in total — under 4 g — so almost any scrap will do.
- Sunny — golden yellow for the petals, chocolate brown for the center
- Waddle — black, plus cream for the chest patch and yellow for the beak
- Spud — warm tan
- **Hook:** 3.5 mm (US E/4)
- **Eyes:** 5 mm black safety eyes ×6 (or embroidery thread — see Safety and selling, below)
- **Fiberfill:** about 3 g in total for all three, or enough to fill each body firmly without lumps
- **Blunt tapestry needle**, stitch marker, scissors

Gauge

Approximately **3.5 mm per stitch** and **3.2 mm per round** in single crochet worked in the round with the stated yarn and hook. Amigurumi is normally worked a half-size tighter than the yarn calls for.

This is a pocket-size set, so gauge matters: a single half-size difference changes the finished size noticeably. Work a gauge swatch before you start. The sizes in the table above are calculated from this gauge.

Skill Level

Easy / beginner-friendly.

Techniques you will use

1. **Magic ring** — the starting loop for Sunny's center and Waddle's body.
2. **Working in a continuous spiral** with a stitch marker, rather than joining each round.
3. **Invisible decreases** (see the note at the end of the pattern).
4. **Clusters worked into one stitch** — Sunny's petals. Three stitches are worked into a single stitch of the round below, which makes them stand out from the center.
5. **Slip stitch edging** between the petals, which flattens the joins.
6. **Oval base worked around a chain** — Spud's potato. You work along one side of a foundation chain,

around the end, back along the other side, and round the other end, increasing at both ends.
7. Sewing and embroidery for Waddle's wings, chest and beak, and Sunny's center and face.

Abbreviations (US terms)

Abbreviation	Meaning
MR	magic ring
sc	single crochet
hdc	half double crochet
inc	increase (2 sc in one stitch)
dec	invisible decrease
sl st	slip stitch
ch	chain
st(s)	stitch(es)
[...] x N	repeat the bracketed sequence N times

Sunny the Sunflower

A cheerful little face that works up in about twenty minutes. The brown center is a small cushion, and nine petals are worked directly into it.

Body — brown center (make 1)

Round	Instructions	Stitches
Rnd 1	6 sc in MR	(6)
Rnd 2	inc in each st around	(12)
Rnd 3	[sc, inc] x6	(18)
Rnd 4	sc in each st around	(18)
Rnd 5	[sc, dec] x6	(12)
Rnd 6	dec x6 — stuff the center firmly before closing	(6)

Fasten off. Weave the tail through the front loops of the remaining 6 stitches, pull tight to close, and weave in the end on the inside.

Petals — yellow (make 1)

Join yellow with a slip stitch into any stitch of **Rnd 3** of the center.

Round	Instructions	Stitches
Petal rnd	[sl st in next st, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st] x9	(36)

Fasten off and weave in the end.

This repeat uses 2 stitches per petal — a slip stitch, then three stitches into the next one — so **nine petals close the round exactly**. The slip stitch sits in the valley between petals and makes them fan outward. Work this round loosely, especially the three stitches in one stitch; if it pulls tight, step up to a 4 mm hook for this round only and return to 3.5 mm afterwards.

Face

Embroider a smiling mouth with black embroidery thread between Rnd 2 and Rnd 3 of the center. Add 5 mm safety eyes (or embroider them) **3 stitches apart** on Rnd 2, centered over the mouth.

Eye spacing. At 3.5 mm per stitch, three stitches is about 10.5 mm between the eyes. Four stitches is about 14 mm, which on this 20 mm face leaves the 5 mm eyes almost touching the rim of the cushion. Use four stitches only if you are embroidering the eyes rather than inserting safety eyes.

Waddle the Penguin

A pear-shaped body, a cream chest patch, two small wings and a beak. Only the wings are sewn on.

Body — black (make 1)

Round	Instructions	Stitches
Rnd 1	6 sc in MR	(6)
Rnd 2	inc in each st around	(12)
Rnd 3	[sc, inc] x6	(18)
Rnd 4-6	sc in each st around, 3 rnd	(18)
Rnd 7	[2 sc, inc] x6	(24)
Rnd 8-9	sc in each st around, 2 rnd	(24)
Rnd 10	[2 sc, dec] x6	(18)
Rnd 11	[sc, dec] x6	(12)
Rnd 12	dec x6 — stuff firmly as you go	(6)

Fasten off. Weave the tail through the remaining 6 stitches and pull tight to close. Weave in the end.

Wings — black (make 2)

Round	Instructions	Stitches
Rnd 1	4 sc in MR	(4)
Rnd 2	[sc, inc] x2	(6)
Rnd 3-4	sc in each st around, 2 rnd	(6)

Fasten off, leaving a 15 cm tail for sewing. Do not stuff.

Chest patch — cream (make 1)

Work this small oval, which is sewn flat onto the front of the body:

Round	Instructions	Stitches
Rnd 1	ch 6, sc in 2nd ch from hook, 3 sc, 3 sc in last ch; working on the other side of the chain: 3 sc, 2 sc in last ch	(12)
Rnd 2	inc, 3 sc, inc x3, 3 sc, inc x2	(18)

Fasten off, leaving a 15 cm tail.

Check the round: a chain of 6 closes at 12 stitches — two stitches for every chain, because the turning chain and the last chain each take a cluster. Rnd 2 uses $1 + 3 + 3 + 3 + 2 = 12$ stitches and produces 18.

Beak — yellow (make 1)

Round	Instructions	Stitches
Rnd 1	ch 2, 3 sc in 2nd ch from hook	(3)
Rnd 2	inc x3	(6)
Rnd 3	sc in each st around	(6)

Fasten off, leaving a 15 cm tail. The beak is tiny — work it with the tail end of the yarn only, and do not stuff it.

Face and assembly

1. Add 5 mm safety eyes **3 stitches apart** on Rnd 3, between Rnd 2 and Rnd 3. (As with Sunny, four stitches leaves the eyes almost at the edge of an 18-stitch face.)
2. Sew the beak centered directly between the eyes, angled slightly downward.
3. Sew the cream chest patch onto the front of the body, covering Rnds 4–8. Stitch along the top and bottom edges only so the middle can puff slightly.
4. Sew the two wings onto the sides at Rnd 6, angled backward as though the penguin were mid-waddle. Pin them first and check the angle before sewing.
5. Add a tiny blush of pink chalk or pastel on the cheeks with a cotton swab. Use it sparingly.

Spud the Potato

A flat, slightly lumpy oval — the shape comes from the seam, not the stitching. No stuffing is needed until the closing step.

Body — warm tan (make 1)

Foundation: ch 7.

Round	Instructions	Stitches
Rnd 1	sc in 2nd ch from hook, 4 sc, 3 sc in last ch; working on the other side of the chain: 4 sc, 2 sc in last ch; place marker to join	(14)
Rnd 2	inc, 4 sc, inc x3, 4 sc, inc x2	(20)
Rnd 3–6	sc in each st around, 4 rnd	(20)
Rnd 7	[3 sc, dec] x4	(16)
Rnd 8	[2 sc, dec] x4	(12)
Rnd 9	[sc, dec] x4	(8)
Rnd 10	dec x4 — begin stuffing at Rnd 9	(4)

Fasten off, leaving a 20 cm tail.

Closing the seam: with the body flat, use the tail to whip stitch the remaining opening closed. Sew along the flat top so the seam reads as the potato's natural crease. Weave in the end on the inside.

Face

Add 5 mm safety eyes (or embroider them) about **5 stitches apart** on the broad side, around Rnd 4. Spud's face is the widest of the three at about 27 mm, so four or five stitches both sit comfortably inside the edge — choose to taste. Embroider a small open mouth below and between the eyes.

Making a Bigger Trio

The three finished sizes above are worked in the round with #4 worsted on a 3.5 mm hook. If you want the toys noticeably larger, switch to a 3.5 mm hook with **chunky or aran weight yarn**, or work #4 worsted held double:

- at about **4.5 mm per stitch** everything scales up by roughly 1.3x
- Sunny about **3.9 cm** across the petals
- Waddle about **4.9 cm** tall
- Spud about **3.5 cm** long

No stitch counts change — the same rounds give the same shapes at the new size. Make a gauge swatch first, because yarns vary.

Safety and Selling

This set is not intended for children under 3. Safety eyes are small parts that can be pulled off and swallowed. Even with safety washers fitted, a determined child can work an eye loose.

If you are making these for young children, **embroider the eyes and mouths with yarn** instead of using safety eyes. Embroidered eyes look just as good at this scale and remove the hazard entirely.

A note for sellers:

- **Do not market these as "baby-safe."** The term has no legal definition in toy safety, and using it as a listing filter invites a claim you cannot support. Toys sold to children in the EU must carry CE marking under EN 71, and in the United States must meet the CPSIA lead and phthalate limits and ASTM F963. Independent testing is the only way to know whether your toys meet those standards.
- Sell them instead as **adult collectibles, desk companions, or keychain charms** — the pocket-size format suits that framing well.
- Include a hang tag or listing line with your **materials, your name as maker, and "Not suitable for children under 3 years."**
- Stuff firmly and evenly. Lumpy or under-stuffed toys read as cheap and lose their shape within weeks.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Petal edges curl	Use invisible decreases on Rnd 5 of Sunny's center and pull the closing round snugly.
Petal round will not close	Nine repeats of the petal sequence use exactly 18 stitches — two per repeat. Make sure you worked Rnd 3 to (18) and that you slip-stitched once per repeat.
The toys come out smaller than the sizes in the table	Your tension is tighter than 3.5 mm per stitch. Work up half a hook size at a time, or hold #4 worsted double — see Making a Bigger Trio.
The toys come out larger than the sizes in the table	Your tension is looser than 3.5 mm per stitch. Drop to a 3 mm hook.
Sunny's petals sit flat instead of standing out	Work the three stitches in one stitch loosely, or step up to a 4 mm hook for the petal round only.
Waddle's wings flop	Sew them at Rnd 6 and catch a stitch of the body with each pass.
Spud's seam shows	Whip stitch along the flat top so the seam reads as a crease, and stuff evenly before closing.
Eyes sit too close to the edge	On Sunny and Waddle use three stitches apart, not four.

Invisible Decrease

An invisible decrease (inv dec) produces a flatter join than a standard decrease, which matters at this scale.

1. Insert your hook under the **front loop only** of the next stitch.
2. Insert your hook under the **front loop only** of the stitch after that. You should have three loops on the hook.
3. Yarn over and pull through the first two loops.
4. Yarn over and pull through both remaining loops.

Care

Spot clean with a damp cloth and mild soap; do not machine wash. Keep away from heat. Surface-fluff any pulled loops with a clean pet slicker brush or a toothbrush.

Pocket Positivity Trio — US crochet terms. Three palm-sized amigurumi: Sunny the Sunflower, Waddle the Penguin, and Spud the Potato.